

[00:00:00.750] - Speaker 1

Okay, hi, my name is Trent and here's Suvi, and we'll be doing an interview about coworkers supporting a colleague with limited language proficiency. So can you tell me a time that you worked closely with a coworker who had a language barrier?

[00:00:20.530] - Speaker 2

I mean, since last week, I guess, because I meet like different people every day and their native language isn't English. So yeah.

[00:00:32.590] - Speaker 1

Can you elaborate, like, where is this coworker from? Like, what nationality is this person? Or like—

[00:00:43.190] - Speaker 2

Well, she's Chinese from— yeah, she's from China. And basically we stick together every day. During weekdays because basically we work together.

[00:00:56.360] - Speaker 1

Okay.

[00:00:57.390] - Speaker 2

Yeah.

[00:00:58.870] - Speaker 1

So, so let's say you're in a, a helping role in your job. So how much extra time or effort does it typically take you to communicate with other people, other coworkers?

[00:01:18.450] - Speaker 2

I mean, I wouldn't say I take long because whenever I need help or when I'm confused with something, I ask right away. So yeah.

[00:01:29.690] - Speaker 1

Okay. Have you ever encountered any miscommunication with the coworkers or like any mistakes, any language mistakes?

[00:01:42.440] - Speaker 2

Yeah, definitely. Sometimes I explain stuff to them and they misunderstood me and, and just do the work right, like right away. Then like the result came out wasn't I expected to be. Then we just sorted out, like I explained it more clearly to them. And yeah, I think that's it.

[00:02:05.730] - Speaker 1

Okay, have you seen your team intentionally exclude like people who don't really have good English language skills? Or like, have you seen them doing like, let's say, talking slowly or like skipping topics to make communication easier?

[00:02:28.730] - Speaker 2

I haven't seen anyone that exclude anyone from the workplace because everyone from The office are pretty friendly and nice and outgoing.

[00:02:41.340] - Speaker 1

Okay. Do you think, like, the person you work with would actually want this type of, like, treatment? Do you think they might get singled out, or do you think we should actually support them more?

[00:03:00.350] - Speaker 2

I mean, if one of the workers feels singled out, of course, like, talk to the other coworkers about it, then we might like come up with a solution to how to like include that, include that like employee into every single thing, or just make them feel not left out.

[00:03:25.290] - Speaker 1

Okay, so final question. So could you see Like, so about our concept. So our concept is a shared robot for like group support for people who have English language difficulties in their workplace, like environment.

[00:03:48.670] - Speaker 2

Mm-hmm.

[00:03:50.090] - Speaker 1

They get to interact with the robot for like communication support for workplace jargon. for all sorts of language support. So do you think it being used could help, like, a team to understand different cultural or communication norms?

[00:04:10.990] - Speaker 2

I think definitely, yeah, because everyone's perspective isn't the same. And sometimes when you explain stuff and your native language isn't English, it might and most likely be hard for you to make others understand like what your point is. And so, so I think the, the 4 bots are really useful.

[00:04:33.990] - Speaker 1

Okay, so you'd say the features are like useful?

[00:04:38.220] - Speaker 2

Yeah.

[00:04:38.570] - Speaker 1

To help people not feel lonely or like in a difficult environment if they don't speak English?

[00:04:47.270] - Speaker 2

Yeah.

[00:04:48.030] - Speaker 1

Okay, nice. Okay, thank you.